but by the very nature of the task this rendering articulate, whether in microcosm or macrocosm, must always fall far short of realising even a fraction of this potential. The images of the signs, then, demand contemplation, not articulation; but contemplation only of what is in these images, so perfectly fitted to that which they represent, not of the sentimental baggage that we carry with us: contemplation of what is there, not of ourselves.

It is a rare chart on which at least one of the *Arabian Parts* cannot shed some light. The Arabian Parts, so called because they were much used by the Arab astrologers, are particular points in the chart each of which tells us about one particular subject. We arrive at these points by means of a simple calculation. For instance, if a horary chart is set for the question, "Is my marriage over?" we would cast the Arabian Part of Marriage and study its condition.

Parts exist for any number of subjects: Al-Biruni, writing in the Eleventh Century, says: "It is impossible to enumerate the lots (i.e. Parts) which have been invented... they increase in number every day."[6] They range from those dealing with obviously important matters, such as the Parts of Victory, Death, or Marriage, to those that are at first puzzling, such as the Parts of Apricots and of Cucumbers. But if you were the farmer wondering when it would be best to take his apricot crop to market, or the Royal Astrologer casting the Aries Ingress chart to examine the nation's fortunes over the coming year, when the size of the cucumber harvest might be of some significance, the importance of even these recondite Parts would become clear.

The position of each Part is determined by a formula which adds the distance between two places in the chart – usually the positions of two of the planets – to a third place, which is usually the Ascendant. The best-known of the Parts, for instance, the Part of Fortune, takes the distance from the Sun to the Moon and then adds this distance to the Ascendant (so Asc + ☽ – ☉). Once the Part has been calculated, we look to see what is happening to it (it is a principle that Parts do not do; they are done to). If our Part of Cucumbers falls conjunct Jupiter, we are suitably delighted; if conjunct Saturn, we are grateful that we chose to diversify this year. Just as with a planet, we will examine its strength – accidental only – and receptions. Most importantly, we will also look to its *dispositor*, the planet that rules the sign in which it falls. The dispositor of the Part represents that thing in the chart: so if the Part of Marriage falls in Aries, its dispositor is Mars, so Mars signifies the marriage. If Mars is strong, in a fixed sign, and with both the spouses' planets showing by reception a strong interest in it, all well and good. If Mars is badly placed and the spouses' planets have no interest in it, there is cause for concern. Similarly with the dispositor of the Part of Cucumbers: if that planet is making a good connection between me and the other people's money, I know it is time to sell.

The greatest value of the Arabian Parts, however, is found when we seek to

[6] Al-Biruni, op. cit. p. 282. Al-Biruni gives a list of the most useful Parts with their formulae. Modern lists of Arabian Parts incorporating Uranus, Neptune and Pluto lack all foundation and are to be disregarded.

peer beneath the superficial reality of the material in order to examine the spiritual reality within. The key Parts are geared to exactly this end, their very existence being evidence of an awe-inspiring knowledge of, and clarity about, spiritual states – a knowledge utterly different from anything contained in the so-called 'esoteric' astrology of the moderns.

The Part of Fortune, based on the Moon, shows the soul; its reverse formula,[7] the Part of Spirit, shows the Spirit (that is, Asc+☉-☽. This is also called the Part of the Sun, or the Part of the Future, the latter presumably because one's final end depends, precisely, on the Spirit). The Part of Faith (Asc+☿-☽) shows the correct or incorrect orientation of the mind. The Ascendant + Part of Spirit – Part of Fortune gives the Part of Love, Friendship and Affection. Its reverse formula, Ascendant + Part of Fortune – Part of Spirit, gives the Part of Despair, Fraud and Penury. Ascendant + Part of Fortune – Mars shows courage or greatness of soul (Part of Valour, Courage). Ascendant + Jupiter – Part of Spirit shows victory and aid from Above (Part of Victory and Aid). Ascendant + Saturn – Part of Fortune shows imprisonment and escape, the wisdom that is born of experience (Part of Captivity and Escape). These are the traditional seven pillars of the spiritual assessment by Arabian Parts, though many other Parts provide important additional information.[8]

Adding the Arabian Parts to the planets completes the cast of players in our drama. We now have all our participants assembled, and have evaluated their strengths by assessing their dignities and their inclinations by assessing the receptions between them. All that remains is to see how these planets and Parts relate to each other by aspect. Aspects are what draw the planets together, allowing them to interact. On many occasions, often but by no means exclusively in horary charts, we shall be looking for specific actions: these will be shown in the chart by aspects reaching exactitude or *perfection*. In many charts, however, we shall be more concerned with describing situations; in these cases, aspects show influence of one thing on another, whether these aspects are exact or not. The closer the aspect, the stronger the influence. An example clarifies the difference in treatment: if I ask a horary question "Did my dog steal the sausages?" and find the planet that signifies my dog just separating from aspect with the planet that shows the sausages, I would find her guilty, as she and the sausages have been in contact in the recent past (a separating aspect showing past action). If, however, I were thinking "What is this dog like? Should I buy her?" this close aspect would help describe her nature, according to the planet concerned.

An important addition to our repertoire of aspects is the *antiscion*, which we saw in action in Hitler's birth-chart. The antiscion of a planet or Arabian Part is

[7] Many astrologers, including Bonatus, reversed these two formulae in night-time charts, such that each became the other; but both the reasoning behind this reversal and its practical application are unconvincing.

[8] Of these, perhaps the most important is the Part of Death, which is given as Asc+8th cusp-Moon and Asc+Saturn-Moon, either (or both) of which can be used.